> During the same year plague and famine visited Gujarat. The rulers considered these the spoils of battle, caused by filth and rotten stench. The pestilence continued for five or six months. People had not witnessed such awful disaster for a long time, they felt utterly helpless and dreadful. Many people left the province and became exiles. The intensity of pestilence was such that every day a hundred cart-loads of dead bodies were taken out of Ahmadabad, which were thrown into ponds and covered with mud. Those were in addition to the dead who were carried on biers and bedsteads and were properly buried. Commodities became so dear that men had to be content with a single loaf of bread per day… Graves could not be dug for burials… Ultimately the deadly pestilence spread over the districts of Pattan, Baroach, Baroda and indeed engulfed the whole of Gujarat… Provision for horses and camels was nowhere to be had. So they scraped the bark of trees, crushed it and made it soft by soaking it in water and fed their cattle on it. Its after effects were numerous.

Gujarat became a subah of the Mughal Empire and the chief zamindar was a Brahmin, one Narain Das who, according to Abu'l Fazl, was 'of such austere life that he first feeds his cattle with corn and then picks up the grains from their dung and makes this his food, a sustenance held in much esteem by the Brahmans. He is regarded as the head of the Rathore tribe and has a following of 500 horse and 10,000 foot [soldiers].'

The indefatigable Raja Todar Mal was appointed Diwan of Gujarat, to rejuvenate its shattered economy and finances. Todar Mal ordered a complete survey of the cultivable land of Gujarat using a uniform method.* Land was now measured using lengths of bamboo instead of the old method of using rope. He also perfected the system of classification of lands on the basis of their actual productive quality and this would result in detailed survey reports which would form the basis for all future tax calculations.† From now on this zabt revenue system, based on regular collection of data on cultivated area, crop prices etc., would be implemented throughout the empire.

In 1573, after being reunited with Mirza Aziz Koka, Akbar returned to Sikri in just three weeks, triumphant. In honour of his tremendous Gujarat victory, the city would be renamed Fathpur Sikri or Fatehpur Sikri (City of